



A BLUFFER'S GUIDE

- 2008 sees a historic first as three BJP MPs wave wads of currency notes in Parliament, claiming they have been bribed by the UPA.
- Kerala Chief Minister V.S. Achuthanandan tells the parents of slain NSG Commando Sandeep Unnikrishnan that had it not been for their son not even a dog would visit them.
- Madhu Koda thumbs his nose at the Enforcement Directorate and campaigns for assembly polls despite being wanted for questioning in a gargantuan scam.

UNHOLIER Than Thou

Politicians have always behaved badly. The surprise is we reelect them, despite corruption, hate mongering and sheer negligence.

By Anuvab Pal |

On a warm blue September day in 2001, Mohammed Atta, an Egyptian architect from Germany, forced his way into the cockpit of American Airlines Flight 11 bound for San Francisco, flew it into the World Trade Center Tower 1 and changed everything. No hostages, No released prisoners, no cash, just this humble Al Qaeda goal: The destruction of free liberal Western democracy as we know it. With the idea unleashed, the decade saw reproductions. India's Parliament in 2001, the Madrid train bombings in 2002, the London transport system in 2004, the Sharm Al-Sheikh hotel

attacks in 2005, the Bali nightclub bombings in 2005, Mumbai 26/11/08. Till the end of the 1990s, people saw terrorists as holding innocent people to bargain for something. The last decade has shown us the willingness of cosmopolitan, educated young, moneyed people using the Internet revolution that's happened in parallel, to be taken in by the appeal of martyrdom and spectacularly kill themselves for Osama Bin Laden.

The world scrambled to react. America led the excitement with the catch phrase, "War Against Terror" and the clear declaration, "Either you're with us or against us". "We're with you", India shouted, "We've known terrorism almost daily, now you know what it feels like to be us" and other